WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

GUINEA CONAKRY

Africa

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Conakry	Capital and principal commercial port city; seat of government, the central bank and the investment agency, and within the Investment Code's Zone A	Financial and business services, port logistics, construction, consumer markets
Boké / Kamsar (northwest)	Heart of the world-class bauxite industry, home to the leading exporters and the Kamsar port, with a proposed LNG terminal under consideration	Bauxite mining, alumina refining, port and marine services, energy
Simandou range (southeast)	Site of the Simandou iron ore project, which began exporting in late 2025 and is ramping up towards 60 million tonnes a year for the Rio Tinto SimFer blocks by H2 2028	Iron ore, mining services, supply chains, local content
Trans-Guinean rail corridor and Simandou ports	A new 600-km main railway, a 70-km mine spur and coastal port facilities linking the interior to global markets	Logistics, rail services, agro-processing along the corridor, industrial zones
Konkouré River basin (Kindia region)	Hydropower backbone of the national grid, with Kaleta (240 MW) and Souapiti (450 MW) operating and Amaria (300 MW) progressing	Hydropower, transmission, energy-intensive industry
Upper Guinea gold belt (Siguiri / Kankan)	Centre of gold production; Guinea exported 49.6 tonnes of gold worth $5 billion in 2025	Gold mining and processing, equipment and services
Middle and Forest Guinea farming regions	Agriculture provides about 32% of GDP and over 60% of jobs, with the World Bank highlighting agri-food value chains as a priority	Agribusiness, post-harvest storage, food processing, logistics

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Agence de Promotion des Investissements Privés (APIP), the national investment agency, operating the one-stop shop (Guichet Unique) for company registration, Investment Code benefits and review of large projects
- Investment Code (Law L/2015/008/AN of 25 May 2015), open to foreign investors in most sectors, with duty exemptions and two- to three-year tax holidays varying between Zone A (Conakry and western prefectures) and Zone B (rest of the country)

- Mining Code (2011, amended by Law L/2013/053) and negotiated mining conventions, administered by the Ministry of Mines and Geology, with government priority on domestic processing of bauxite into alumina
- Investor protection through ICSID membership (since 1968) and bilateral investment treaties, such as the Guinea–Germany treaty in force since 2014
- Banque Centrale de la République de Guinée (BCRG) management of the Guinean franc; mining and gold exporters must repatriate a share of export proceeds (60% for gold), and the new IMF-supported programme promotes greater exchange-rate flexibility
- Simandou 2040 programme of 122 megaprojects and 36 reforms, targeting over $200 billion of investment by 2040, with a planned Sovereign Fund of Guinea designed in line with the Santiago Principles
- Energy and hydrocarbons entry through independent power projects (including plans for up to 500 MW of solar) and a licensing round covering 22 onshore and offshore oil blocks

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Guinea in October 2026 is one of Africa's fastest-growing economies, as Simandou iron ore exports ramp up alongside record bauxite output. GDP grew by around 7% in 2025, and the World Bank projects 8.8% growth in 2026 and 11.6% in 2027. Foreign direct investment rose more than fivefold to about $8 billion in 2025, according to UNCTAD, and bauxite exports hit a record 114.8 million tonnes in H1 2026. Macroeconomic buffers are strengthening: reserves rose to $4.5 billion (4.8 months of imports) in Q1 2026, inflation was 5.9% in September, and the BCRG cut its policy rate to 9.5% in March. S&P moved its B+ rating to a positive outlook in March 2026, constitutional order was restored through the 2025–2026 elections, ECOWAS lifted all remaining sanctions, and an IMF staff-level agreement on a $425 million, 41-month programme was reached in August 2026.

Guinea's central structural challenge is to turn its mineral wealth into broad-based, diversified growth while giving investors a predictable framework. Around 95% of exports are mining products, and since 2024 the government has pursued a more assertive mining policy: it revoked 129 expired exploration permits in 2025 and transferred the GAC bauxite concession to the state-backed Nimba Mining Company, with some disputes, including an ICSID claim by Axis Minerals, still pending. The direction of travel is constructive: Guinea reached an amicable settlement with Emirates Global Aluminium in May 2026, the IMF programme supports mining revenue transparency and governance reforms, and a sovereign fund is planned to save part of the mineral windfall. For investors, the government's priority on local processing, power generation and agriculture creates substantial opportunity in alumina refining, energy, logistics and agri-food value chains.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Mining regulatory policy and licence reviews	The 2025 review of the mining cadastre led to permit revocations and a concession transfer; the EGA dispute was settled in May 2026, though some claims remain open	Secure clear conventions, meet development milestones and retain mining counsel; aligning projects with local-processing goals strengthens the investor's position
Domestic processing expectations	The government is encouraging bauxite operators to commit to in-country alumina refining	Treat refining as an opportunity: partner with operators and the state on refinery, power and port projects that match national priorities
Concentration on mining and commodity prices	Mining dominates exports, and softer iron ore and bauxite prices in 2026 affect revenues and smaller miners	The IMF programme, planned sovereign fund and Simandou 2040 diversification agenda are building buffers; non-mining sectors offer diversified exposure
Governance and political environment	Constitutional order has been restored through 2025–2026 elections, although 40 parties were dissolved in March 2026 and the main opposition boycotted the legislative vote	Full ECOWAS and AU reintegration and IMF-backed anti-corruption reforms support stability; apply strong compliance and stakeholder engagement
Foreign exchange and liquidity	Export-proceed repatriation rules apply, and the IMF notes cash shortages and buffers below desired levels, although reserves rose to 4.8 months of imports in	Plan treasury and repatriation with established banks; the IMF programme supports exchange-rate flexibility and reserve accumulation

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	Q1 2026	
Infrastructure and energy costs	Rainy seasons, fuel price rises and grid gaps raise operating costs, particularly for inland and mid-sized operations	New rail, port and hydropower capacity is reducing costs and creating investment openings in power, logistics and storage
Simandou ramp-up execution	Construction was paused briefly after a fatality in February 2026, but the SimFer port was 92% complete by Q3 and output is rising quickly	Build phased ramp-up scenarios into supplier and services planning; the 60 Mt-a-year target for H2 2028 offers a long contract pipeline

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Guinea's risk profile reflects a resource-rich economy moving rapidly into a higher-growth phase, with strengthening institutions and external buffers. The restoration of constitutional order, full reintegration into ECOWAS and the African Union, a positive S&P outlook and a new IMF-supported programme together mark a substantial improvement in the investment environment since 2024. The principal consideration for investors is regulatory: the state has taken a firmer approach to mining licences and domestic processing, and some disputes remain before international tribunals, although the May 2026 settlement with EGA shows a willingness to resolve differences amicably. The political environment remains centred on the presidency, with limited opposition participation in the 2026 legislative vote, so sound compliance and stakeholder engagement are advisable. Investors who align with national priorities in processing, energy and diversification, structure projects with clear conventions and ICSID protection, and plan prudently for currency and logistics conditions are well placed to share in one of Africa's strongest growth stories.

MARKET ACCESS

Guinea is a member of ECOWAS, which lifted all remaining sanctions and fully reintegrated the country in January 2026 and of the Mano River Union with Sierra Leone and Liberia. It is a WTO member and participates in the African Continental Free Trade Area. China is the dominant export market, taking a record 74% of bauxite shipments in 2025 and all Simandou iron ore, while India and the UAE are also major export destinations. The new Simandou railway and ports, alongside Kamsar and the Port of Conakry, are expanding export capacity, and the World Bank encourages using the Simandou corridor to connect farmers and producers to domestic and regional markets. The Guinea–Mali power interconnection within the West African Power Pool will further strengthen regional links.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Presidency of the Republic (Mamadi Doumbouya)	Sets national strategy, including the Simandou 2040 programme, mining policy and domestic-processing priorities	Primary reference point for strategic direction and large-scale project alignment
Agence de Promotion des Investissements Privés (APIP)	National investment agency running the one-stop shop and Investment Code approvals	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentive guidance
Banque Centrale de la République de Guinée (BCRG)	Monetary authority managing the Guinean franc, reserves and export-proceed repatriation rules	Relevant for currency, banking and treasury planning
Ministry of Mines and Geology (Bouna Sylla)	Grants and reviews mining titles and negotiates mining conventions, including refining commitments	Essential counterpart for any mining or mining-services investment
Ministry of Economy, Finance and Budget (Mariama Ciré Sylla)	Leads the IMF programme, fiscal policy and the design of the Sovereign Fund of Guinea	Key for tax, fiscal-stability and co-investment discussions
Ministry of Plan and International Cooperation (Ismaël Nabé)	Coordinates development partners and the Simandou 2040 project pipeline	Useful for PPPs and DFI-backed infrastructure projects

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Simandou partners (Rio Tinto SimFer and Winning Consortium Simandou)	Operators of Guinea's largest mining, rail and port development, with major procurement needs	Key counterparts for suppliers, logistics and services investors

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

APIP is the main facilitation channel for foreign investors and has hosted successive editions of the Guinea Investment Forum in Conakry. Guinea's ministers also promote the country at international events, such as the Invest in African Energy Forum in Paris in 2026. The World Bank Group approved a new partnership framework and $293 million of financing in June 2026, and the IMF programme anchors wider donor engagement, creating co-financing openings with development finance institutions. Major mining operators, including Rio Tinto, Chalco, Société Minière de Boké and CBG, maintain large in-country teams and are a valuable source of practical intelligence on logistics, procurement and local content.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Guinea suits investors with a long-term horizon and an appetite for frontier growth: mining and metals companies and their suppliers, particularly those able to support bauxite refining and Simandou's ramp-up; infrastructure and energy investors in hydropower, solar, transmission, rail and ports; agribusiness and food-processing investors building on agriculture's large share of output and jobs; and DFIs and co-investors partnering with the state on the Simandou 2040 programme. Investors should be comfortable with negotiated conventions, active government policy in natural resources and a market that is still building its financial depth.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage APIP and confirm Investment Code eligibility
Use the one-stop shop to register, establish Zone A or Zone B incentive terms and determine whether a negotiated convention is needed.

STEP 2: Align projects with domestic-processing and Simandou 2040 priorities
Position investments to support refining, power, logistics or agri-food value chains, which strengthens long-term standing with the government.

STEP 3: Secure strong legal and contractual protection
Retain local mining and corporate counsel, confirm title and milestone obligations, and structure through jurisdictions with bilateral investment treaty and ICSID coverage.

STEP 4: Plan currency, repatriation and liquidity arrangements
Agree treasury arrangements with established banks early, taking account of BCRG repatriation rules and reforms under the IMF-supported programme.

STEP 5: Build relationships with the Simandou and bauxite operators and DFIs
Engage major operators on procurement and local content, and approach the World Bank Group and other DFIs on co-financing and risk cover.